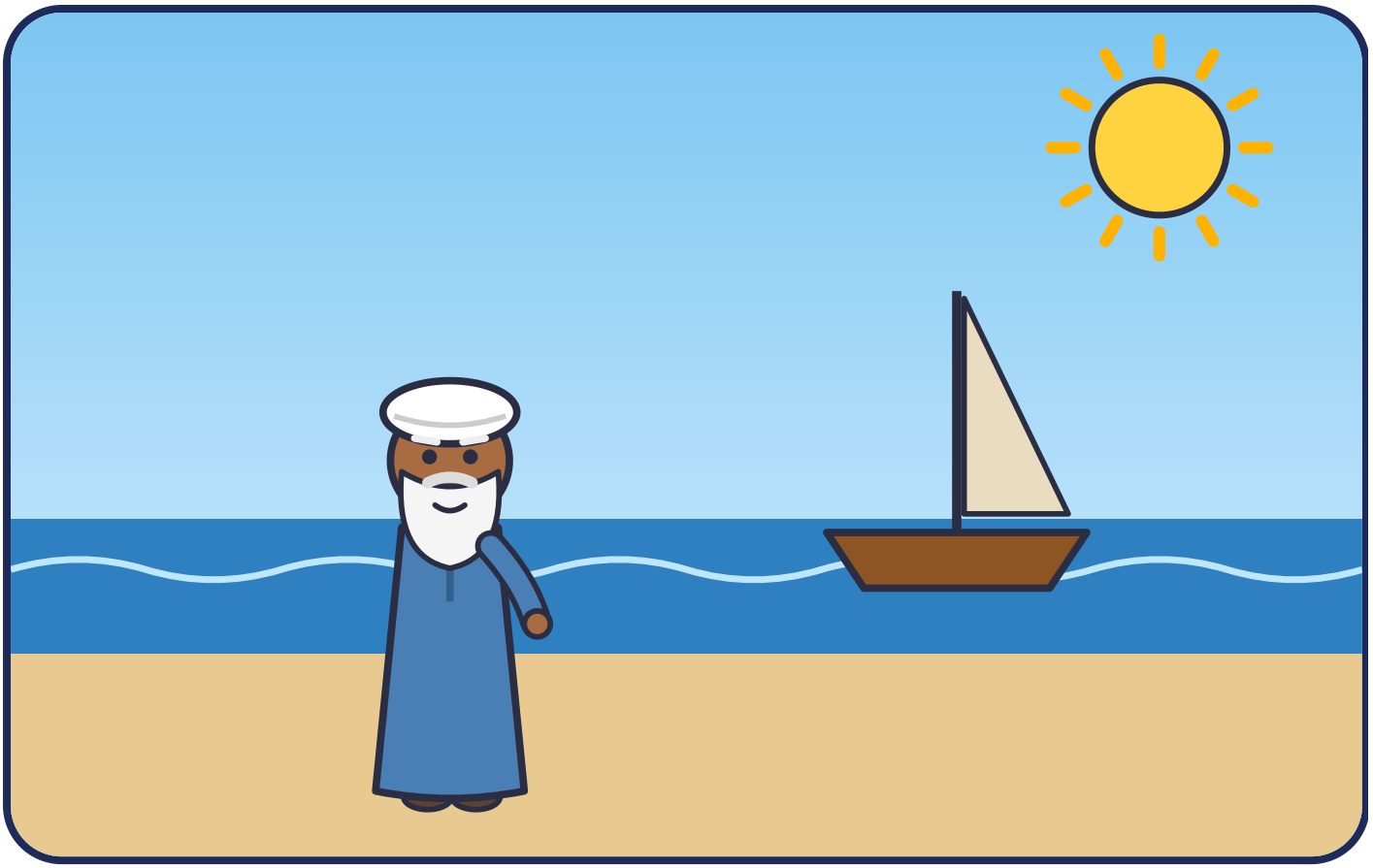
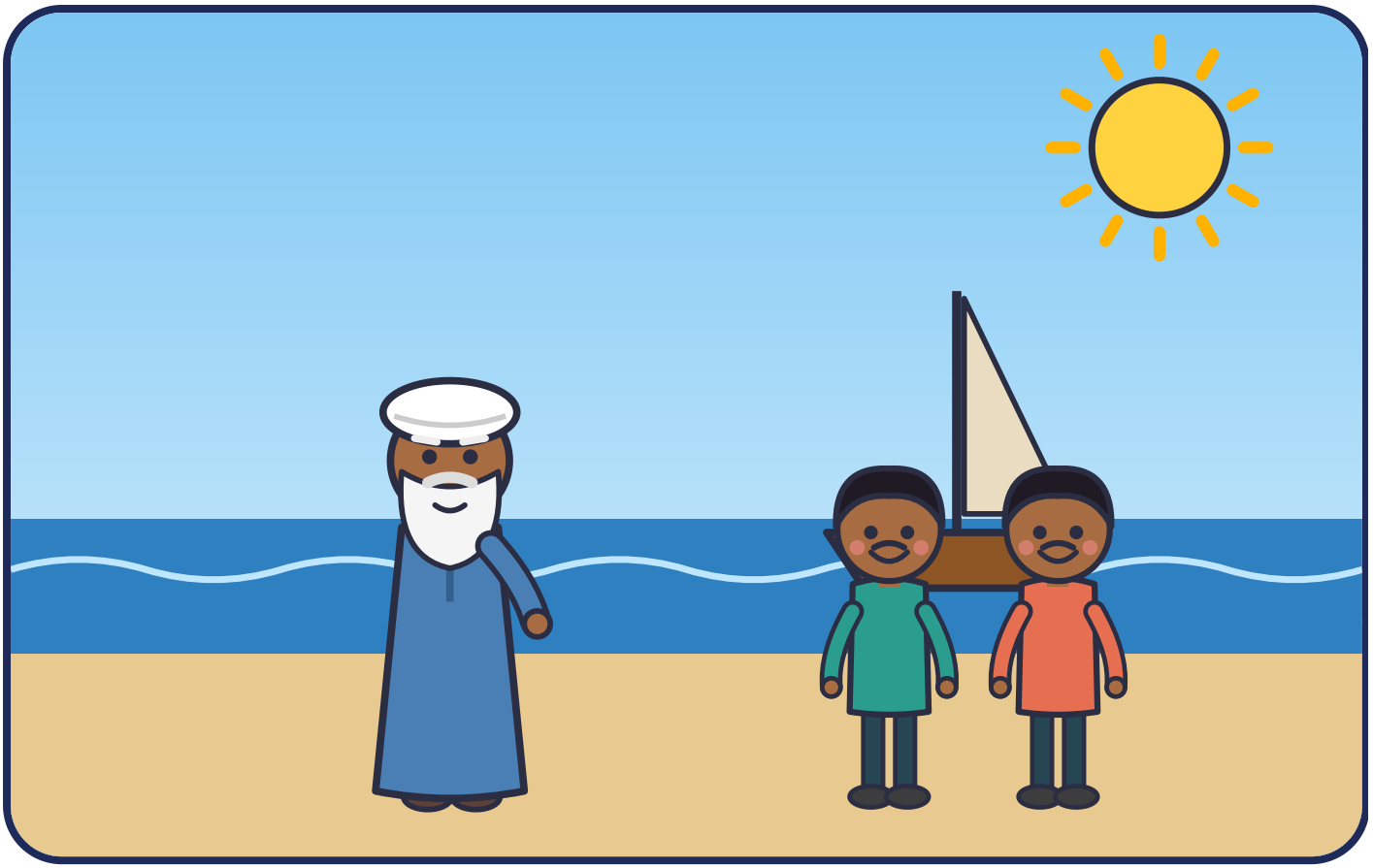


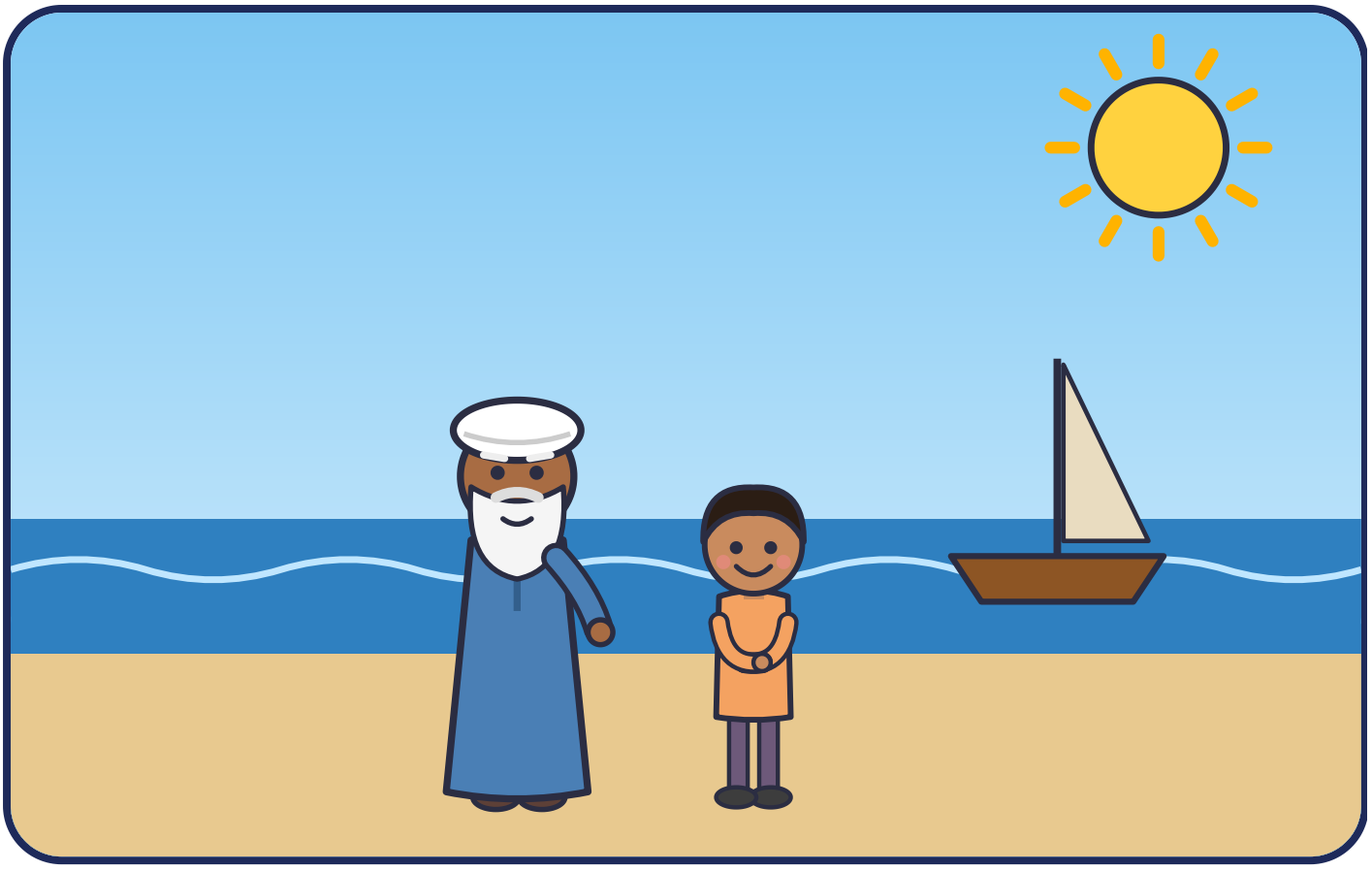
The Old Man and the Sea – Chapters 1 & 2

Retold from Chapters 1 & 2 · English Mood Academy · Sec.1

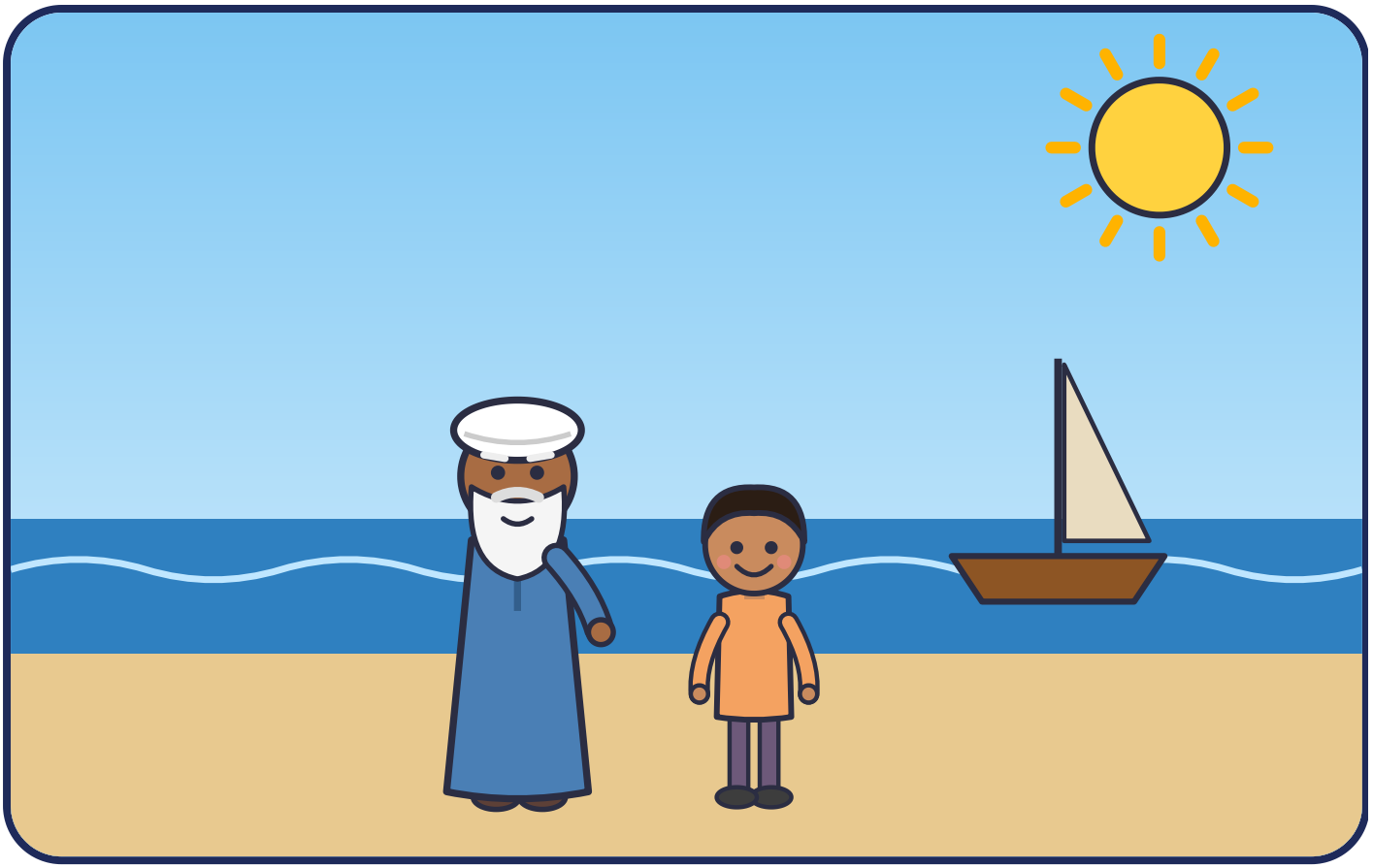
yellow = new words **red** = Past Simple verbs



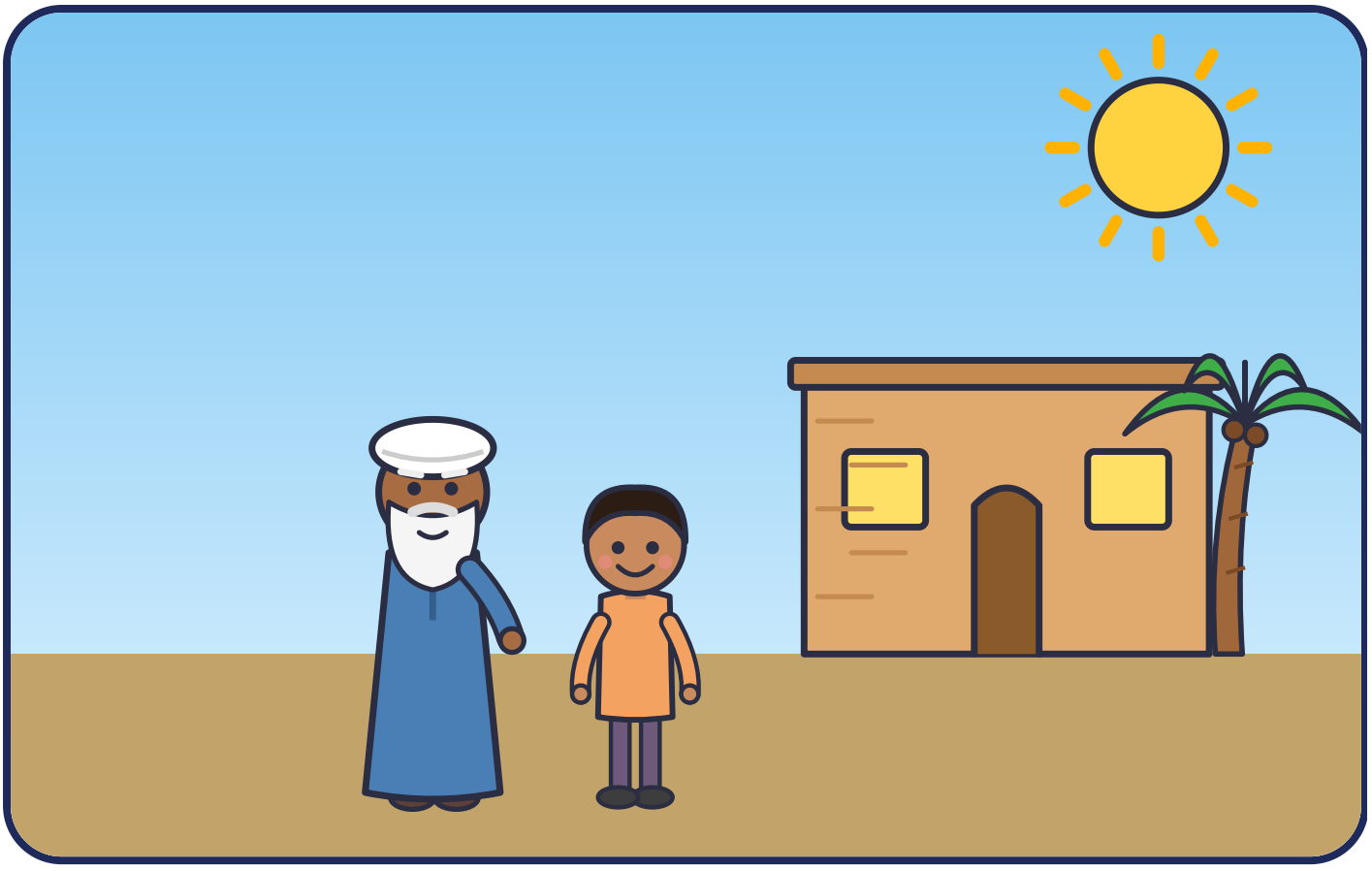
Santiago **was** an old **fisherman**, and the sea **was** his **companion**. His skin **was** dark and **leathery**, and his hands **were** rough and **scarred**. But his eyes **were** clear and bright, full of **determination**.



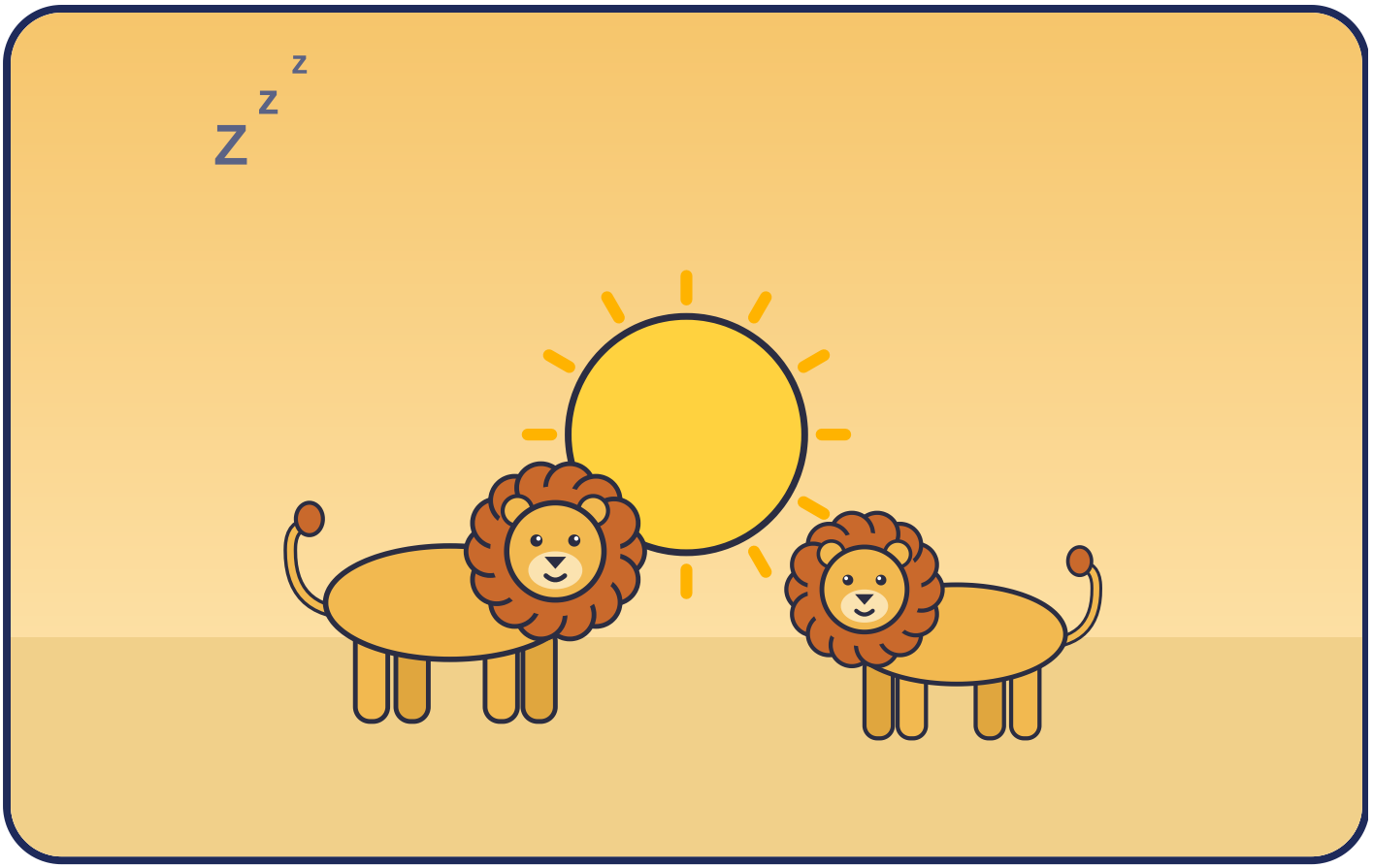
For eighty-four days he **came** back **empty-handed**. **Whispers** **spread** in the village, and the young fishermen **called** him salao, the worst kind of unlucky. Still, he **walked** with **dignity** and his **fishing gear** on his shoulder.



Only one boy **stayed** **loyal**: Manolin. He **loved** the old man with **admiration**. His parents **sent** him to a luckier boat, but every evening he **helped** Santiago carry the **gaff** and the **harpoon** from the **skiff**, and he would **fold the patched sail**.



"Luck will return to you," the boy **said**. Santiago **smiled** **faintly**. "I would rather be **exact**," he **answered**. The boy **nodded**. Fishing **was** not only luck; it **was** skill, **patience** and **courage**.



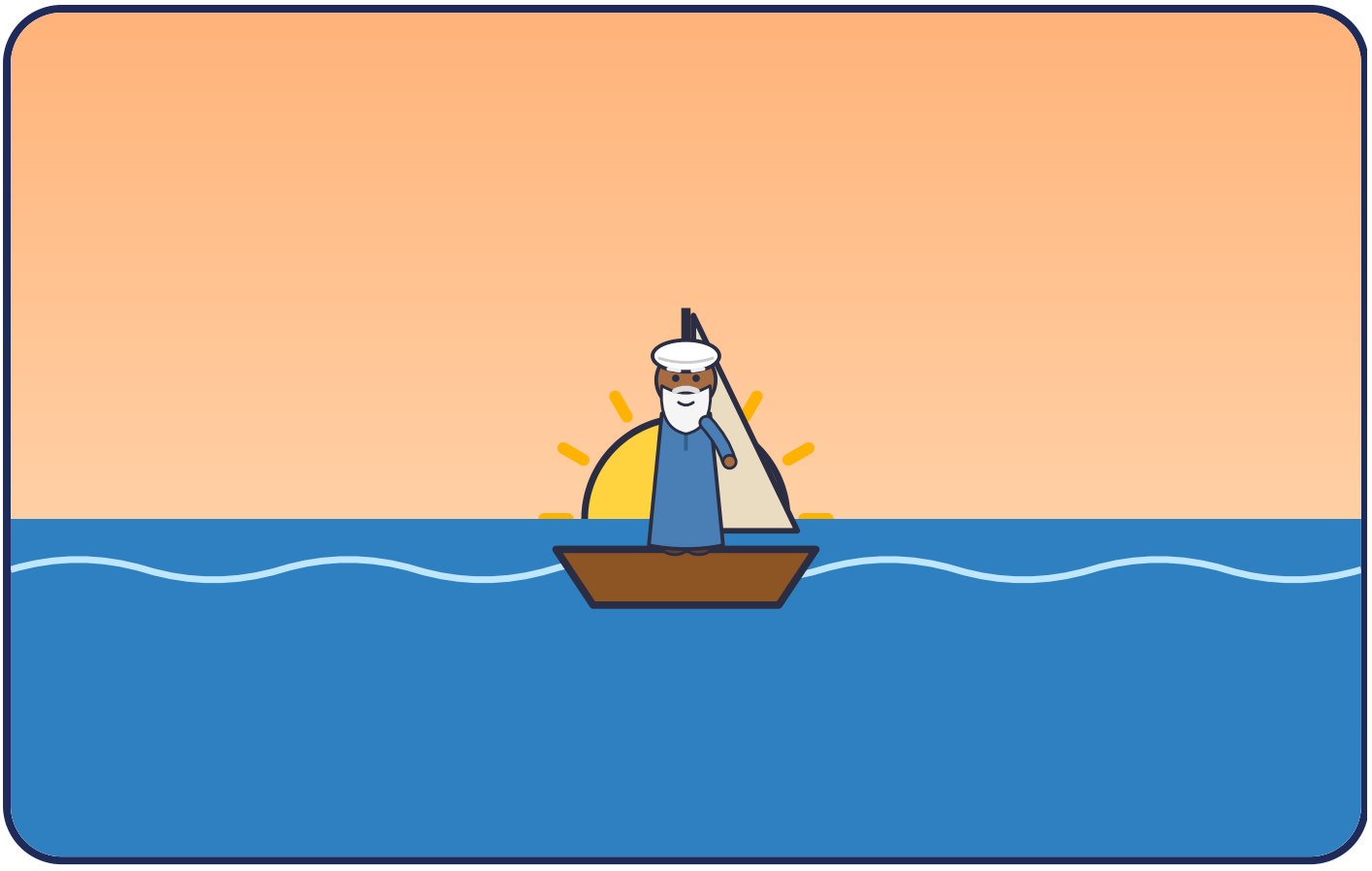
Santiago's **hut** **was** small and almost empty: a bed of newspapers, a table and one chair. There **were** no **luxuries** and no **treasures**. They **ate** black beans and rice, and **talked** about baseball. Joe DiMaggio **was** his **champion**; he **played** even with pain in his **heel**. The boy **grinned**.



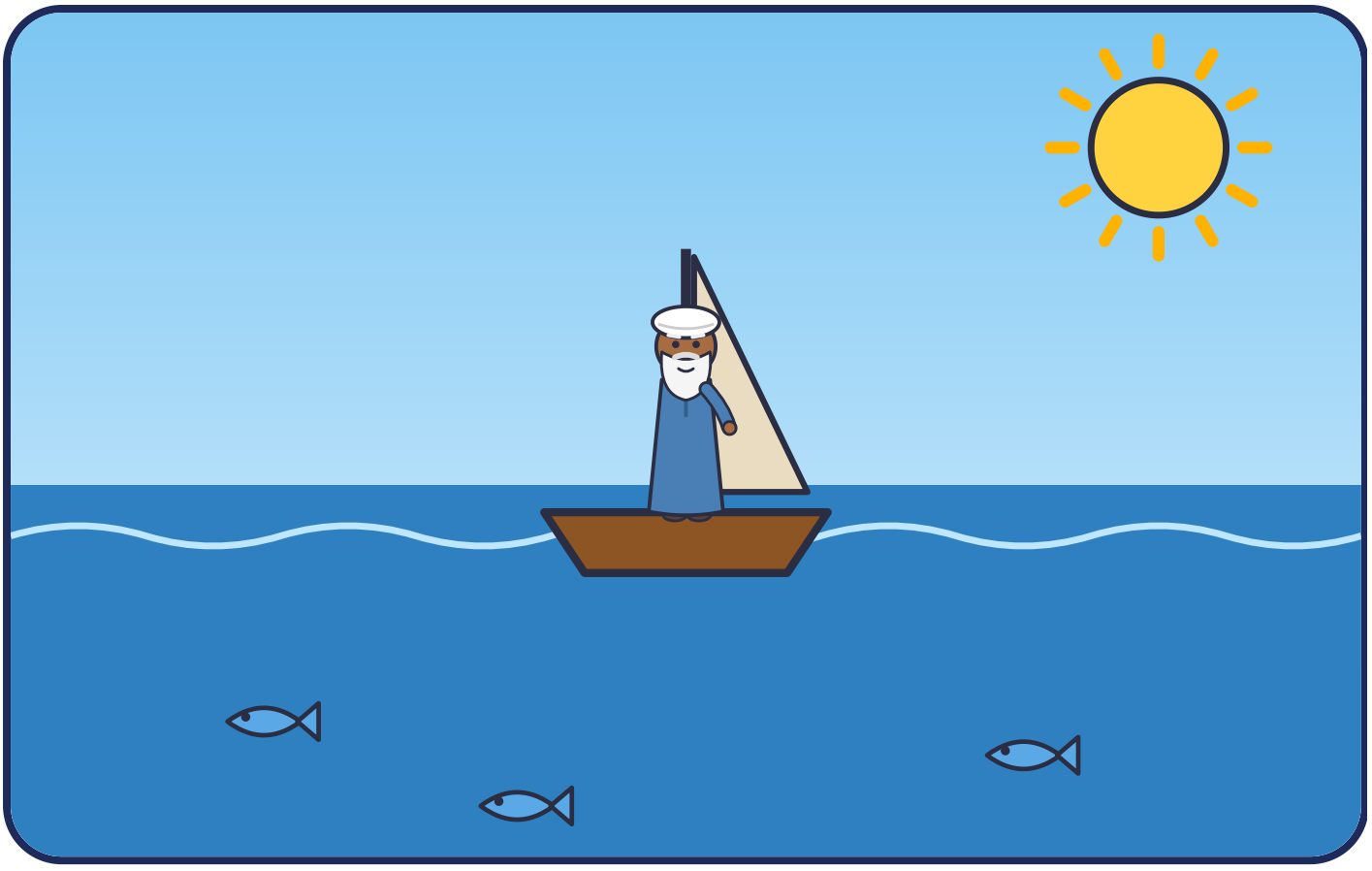
Later, Santiago's thoughts **drifted back** to his youth in Africa, where young lions **played** on golden beaches. That night he **dreamed** of the lions again. In his dream he **was** young and **fearless**. Tomorrow **was** the eighty-fifth day.



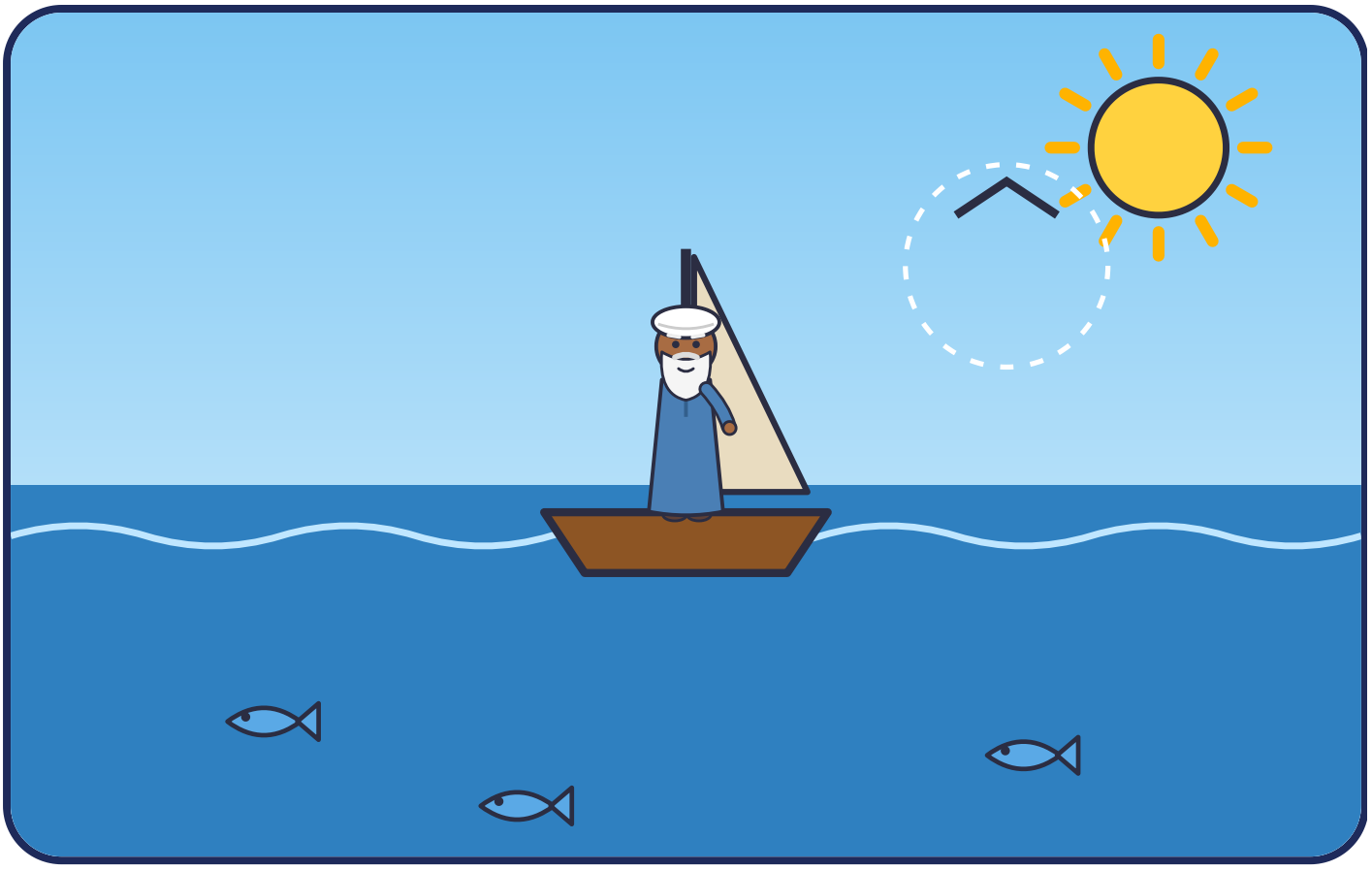
Before sunrise, Santiago **woke** up and **picked** up his **coil of lines**. Manolin **brought** food **wrapped** in paper. "I will need my **strength** today," the old man **said**. Together they **walked** to the **harbor**.



Some fishermen **looked** at Santiago with respect, others with **pity**. He **ignored** them all. The boy **loaded** the gear into the skiff. On the **dock** they **sipped** warm coffee. The air smelled of salt and **tar**. "Eighty-five is my number," Santiago **told** the boy. He believed the patched sail would take him to his **destiny**.



At **dawn**, Santiago **rowed** out alone with **steady** arms. He **felt** the **rhythm** of the **oars** and **heard** the cries of **seabirds**. Soon the sea **stretched** wide and endless to the **horizon**. He **went** farther than the others dared.



He **baited** his lines with sardines and **worked** with **precision**, because **exactness** **brought** luck. Small fish **tugged at the bait**, but he **waited**. By noon **sweat** ran down his back. Skill and **endurance** mattered more than luck. A bird **circled** over the water, and he **knew** his moment would come.

The End 🌊

True victory lies in refusing to give up: skill, patience and hope matter more than luck.

النصر الحقيقي إنك ما تستسلمش: المهارة والصبر والأمل أهم من الحظ.

Words from the story

fisherman	صيّاد
companion	رفيق
leathery	مصنوع من الجلد / خشن كالجلد
scarred	به ندوب (آثار جروح قديمة)
determination	عزيمة
empty-handed	فارغ اليدين
whispers	همسات
dignity	كرامة / عزة
fishing gear	أدوات الصيد
loyal	وفي
admiration	إعجاب
gaff	خطاف الصيد / رمح قصير
harpoon	رمح صيد
skiff	قارب خفيف
fold the patched sail	يطوي الشراع المرقّع
faintly	بضعف / بهدوء
exact	دقيق
nod	يهز رأسه
patience	صبر
courage	شجاعة
hut	كوخ
luxury	رفاهية
treasure	كنز
champion	بطل
heel	كعب القدم
grin	يبتسم
drift back	ينجرف راجعًا
fearless	بلا خوف
coil of lines	بكرة من الخيط
wrapped	مغلف
strength	قوة
harbor	ميناء
pity	شفقة
ignore	يتجاهل
load	يحمل / يملأ
dock	رصيف الميناء
sip	يشرب ببطء
tar	مادة القار أو الأسفلت
destiny	قدر
dawn	الفجر
row	يجدف
steady	ثابت / مستقر
rhythm	نغم / إيقاع
oar	مجداف
seabird	طائر بحري
stretch	يتمدد
horizon	أفق
bait	يضع الطعم / طُعم (لصيد السمك)
precision	دقة / إحكام
exactness	دقة
tug at the bait	تشد الطعم
sweat	عرق
endurance	تحمّل

Past Simple verbs in the story

be → **was / were** * · come → **came** * · spread → **spread** * · call → **called** · walk → **walked** · stay → **stayed** · love → **loved** · send → **sent** * · help → **helped** · say → **said** * · smile → **smiled** · answer → **answered**

eat → **ate** * talk → **talked** play → **played** dream → **dreamed / dreamt** wake → **woke** * pick → **picked** bring → **brought** * look → **looked** tell → **told** * feel → **felt** * hear → **heard** * go → **went** * work → **worked** wait → **waited** circle → **circled** know → **knew** *

* = irregular verb